

**Ahmedabad
University**

CSE400 Fundamentals of Probability in Computing Project Viva

Adaptive Traffic Signal Control using Las Vegas Algorithm

s1_g7_its

Background and Motivation

- Urban traffic is stochastic and time-varying
- Fixed-time signals assume predictable flow → inefficient

- **Real-World Need:**

- Congestion, delays, fuel wastage
- Poor utilization of green signals

- **Course Perspective:**

- Modeled using probability (Poisson) and queues
- Requires decision-making under uncertainty

Motivation

Need for adaptive + probabilistic control

Base Paper Overview

- Uses Webster / Modified Webster for cycle time
- Extends to adaptive control using fuzzy logic
- **Key Idea:**
 - Compute cycle time → adjust using real-time data
- **Contribution:**
 - Adaptive signal timing
 - Reduced waiting time and congestion
- **Limitation**
 - Relies on rule-based (fuzzy) adjustment

Problem Formulation

- **System :**

- Multi-lane intersection
- Random vehicle arrivals (Poisson)
- Each lane = queue

- **Decision Variable:**

- Green time per lane

- **Objective:**

- Minimize:
 - Average waiting time
 - Queue length

- **Nature :**

- Stochastic, time-dependent system

- **Assumptions :**

- Poisson arrivals
- Fixed phases, no skipping
- Constant saturation flow

Mathematical Modeling

Random Variable	Meaning	Distribution	Units
A_i	Vehicle arrivals	Poisson(λ)	vehicles/time-step
δ_i	Green time adjustment	Uniform (biased)	multiplier
Q_i	Queue length	Stochastic (derived)	vehicles
W_i	Waiting time	Stochastic (derived)	time-step

Mathematical Modeling

- **Vehicle arrivals :**

- Vehicle arrivals are very random in nature

$$A_i(t) \sim \text{Poisson}(\lambda_i)$$

where,

λ_i : average arrival rate per lane

- **Queue length :**

- Each lane behaves like an individual queue.

$$Q_i(t + 1) = Q_i(t) + A_i(t) - D_i(t)$$

where,

$Q_i(t)$: number of vehicles in lane i at time t

$A_i(t)$: arrivals

$D_i(t)$: departures

Mathematical Modeling

- **Waiting time approximation :**

$$W_i = \frac{Q_i}{\lambda_i}$$

- **Green time adjustment :**

$$g_i = \alpha_i \cdot C_e + g_{\min}$$

- **Objective function :**

$$\min \frac{1}{N} \sum W_i$$

Deterministic Approach

- A **deterministic approach** is a modeling or computational method where the same input always produces the exact same output, with no randomness or uncertainty.
- **Baseline Strategy :**
 - Use fixed mathematical formulas (Webster / Modified Webster)
 - Inputs are treated as exact values (no randomness in decision logic)
 - Predefined cycle length and green splits computed analytically
 - Same decision rule applied on every simulation run
- **Cycle time formula :**

$$C_o = \frac{1.5L + 5}{1 - \sum y_i}$$

where,

$$y_i = \frac{\text{flow}}{\text{saturation}}$$

Randomized Approach (Las Vegas)

- A **Las Vegas algorithm** will always produce the correct answer.
- **Core Ideation :**
 - Introduce controlled randomness over deterministic solution.
 - Enable exploration of better signal allocations.
- **Methodology :**
 - Initialize with Webster-based green times.
 - Generate multiple candidate solutions.
 - Apply biased perturbation to each lane.

$$\delta_i \sim \text{Uniform (biased)} \quad g'_i = g_i \cdot \delta_i$$

- **Selection strategy :**
 - Evaluate all candidate configurations.
 - Choose the one with minimum average waiting time.

Coding and Simulation

- **End-to-End System Pipeline :**

- SUMO (Simulation of Urban Mobility) as a simulator of the traffic intersection.
- Python is used for the logic implementation and backend control.
- TraCI (Traffic Control Interface) is used as a connection between Python and SUMO.



Coding and Simulation

- **SUMO :**

- "Simulation of Urban MObility" (SUMO) is an open source, highly portable, microscopic and continuous traffic simulation package designed to handle large networks.
- It allows for intermodal simulation including pedestrians and comes with a large set of tools for scenario creation.

- **TraCI :**

- TraCI is the short term for "Traffic Control Interface". Giving access to a running road traffic simulation.
- It allows to retrieve values of simulated objects and to manipulate their behavior "on-line".

Coding and Simulation

```
def deterministic_step(Q):  
  
    arrivals_list = []  
    yi_list = []  
    cycle_time = 60  
  
    for i in range(LANES):  
        arrivals = sample_arrivals(lambda_i[i])  
        arrivals_list.append(arrivals)  
  
        flow = arrivals * 3600.0 / max(cycle_time, 1e-6)  
        yi = flow / 1800.0  
        yi_list.append(max(yi, 1e-6))  
  
    y_sum = sum(yi_list)  
    L = LANES * 3.0  
  
    Co = (1.5 * L + 5.0) / max((1 - y_sum), 1e-6)  
    Co = max(40.0, min(Co, 120.0))  
  
    greens = []  
    Ce = max(Co - L - LANES * 10.0, 0.0)  
  
    for yi in yi_list:  
        alpha = yi / y_sum if y_sum > 1e-9 else 1.0 / LANES  
        gi = alpha * Ce + 10.0  
        greens.append(gi)  
  
    new_Q = []  
    total_wait = 0  
  
    for i in range(LANES):  
        arrivals = arrivals_list[i]  
  
        service = mu_i[i] * (greens[i] / Co)  
        departures = min(Q[i], int(service * Co))  
  
        Qi = max(Q[i] + arrivals - departures, 0)  
        Wi = Qi / max(lambda_i[i], 1e-6)  
  
        total_wait += Wi  
        new_Q.append(Qi)  
  
    return new_Q, total_wait / LANES
```

Implementation of deterministic traffic signal control using Webster's cycle time formulation



Coding and Simulation

```
def las_vegas_step(Q, trials=50):

    # Baseline
    det_Q, det_wait = deterministic_step(Q)

    arrivals_list = []
    yi_list = []
    cycle_time = 60

    for i in range(LANES):
        arrivals = sample_arrivals(lambda_i[i])
        arrivals_list.append(arrivals)

        flow = arrivals * 3600.0 / max(cycle_time, 1e-6)
        yi = flow / 1800.0
        yi_list.append(max(yi, 1e-6))

    y_sum = sum(yi_list)
    L = LANES * 3.0

    Co = (1.5 * L + 5.0) / max((1 - y_sum), 1e-6)
    Co = max(40.0, min(Co, 120.0))

    base_greens = []
    Ce = max(Co - L - LANES * 10.0, 0.0)

    for yi in yi_list:
        alpha = yi / y_sum if y_sum > 1e-9 else 1.0 / LANES
        gi = alpha * Ce + 10.0
        base_greens.append(gi)

    Q_array = np.array(Q)
    weights = Q_array / max(np.sum(Q_array), 1e-6)

    best_Q = det_Q
    best_wait = det_wait
    best_score = det_wait
    best_deltas = [1]*LANES
```

```
for _ in range(trials):

    trial_Q = []
    total_wait = 0
    deltas = []

    for i in range(LANES):

        bias = 1 + 0.8 * weights[i]
        noise = random.uniform(0.8, 1.2)

        delta = max(0.7, min(bias * noise, 1.8))
        deltas.append(delta)

        gi = base_greens[i] * delta

        service = mu_i[i] * (gi / Co)
        departures = min(Q[i], int(service * Co))

        arrivals = arrivals_list[i]

        Qi = max(Q[i] + arrivals - departures, 0)
        Wi = Qi / max(lambda_i[i], 1e-6)

        total_wait += Wi
        trial_Q.append(Qi)

    avg_wait = total_wait / LANES
    avg_queue = sum(trial_Q) / LANES

    score = 0.7 * avg_wait + 0.3 * avg_queue

    if (score < best_score) and (avg_wait <= det_wait):
        best_score = score
        best_wait = avg_wait
        best_Q = trial_Q
        best_deltas = deltas

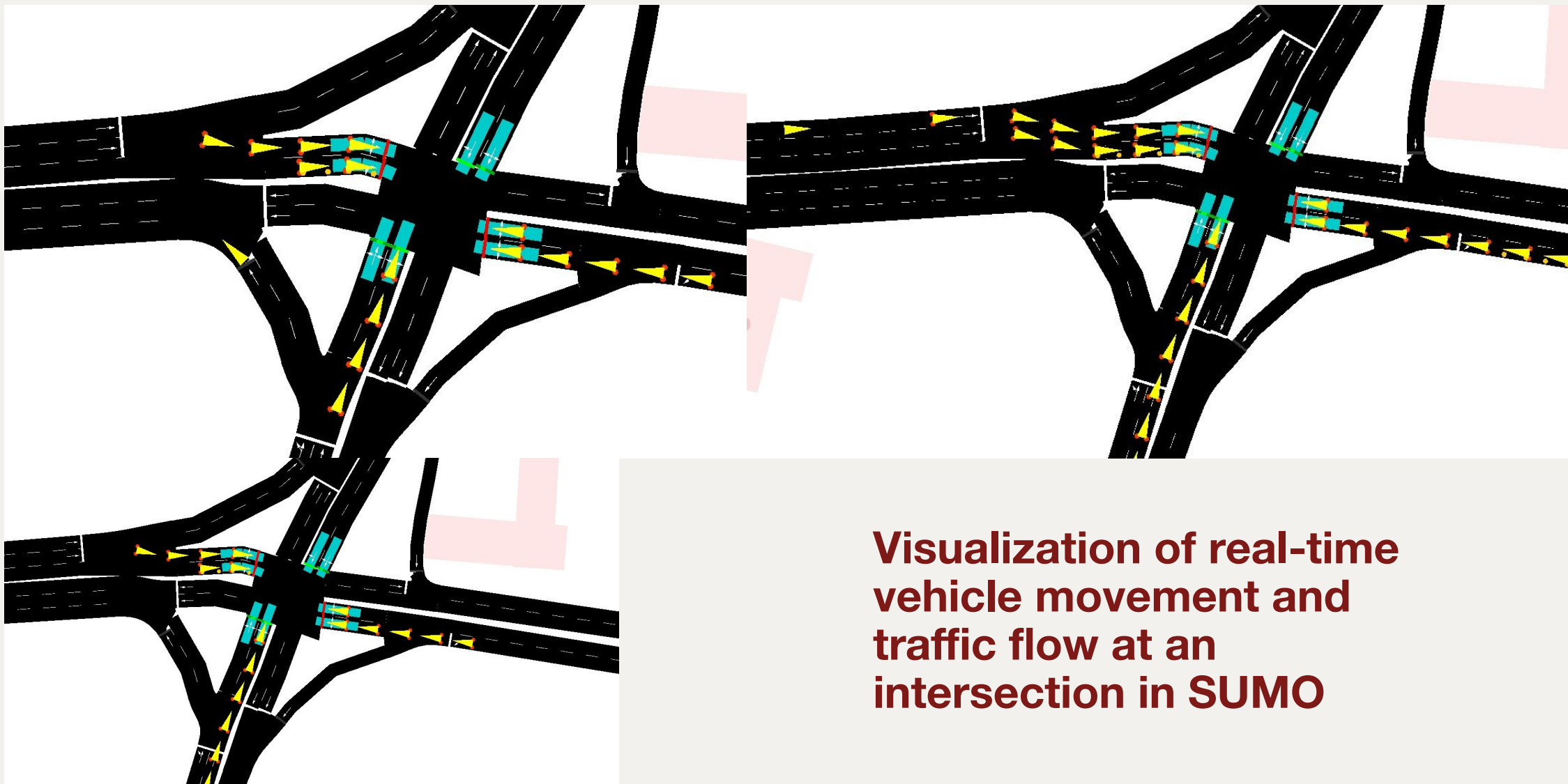
    if best_wait > det_wait:
        return det_Q, det_wait, [1]*LANES

return best_Q, best_wait, best_deltas
```

**Randomized optimization
with Las Vegas Algorithm
ensuring improvement
over deterministic
baseline**

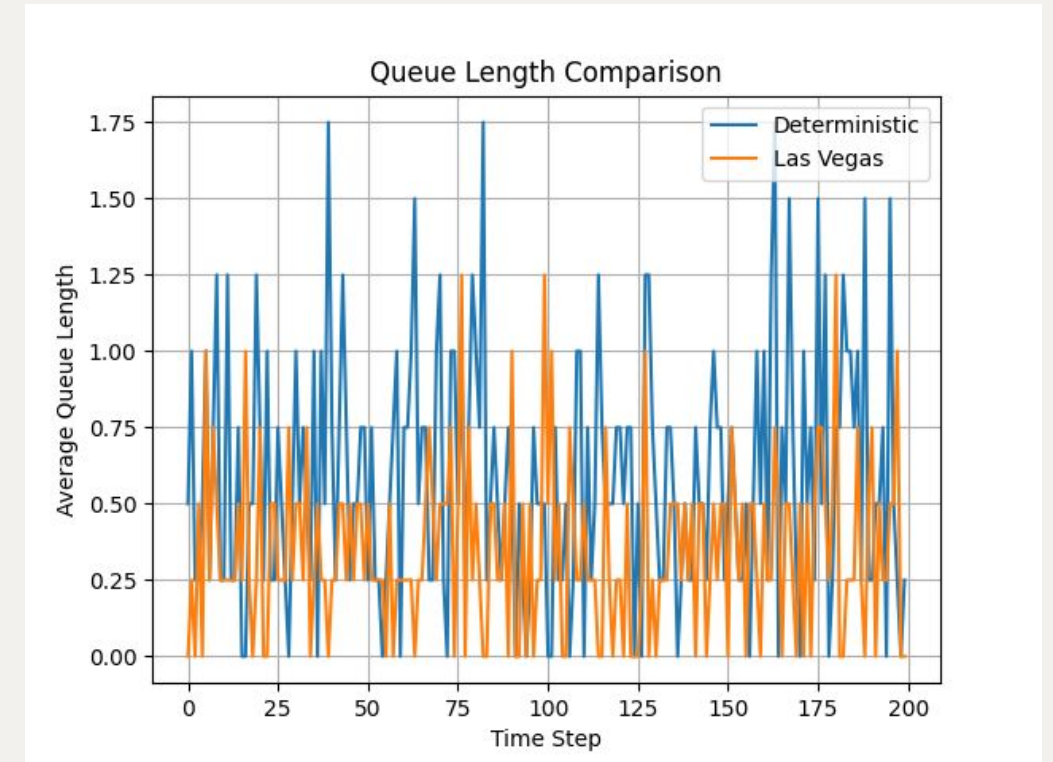
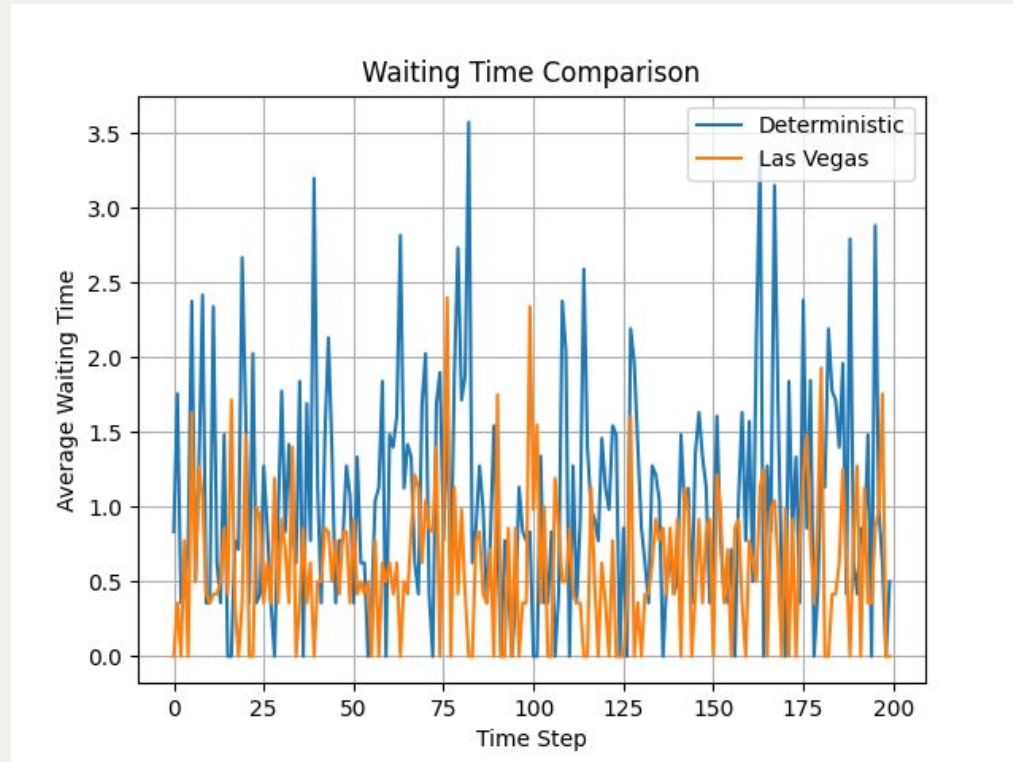


Coding and Simulation



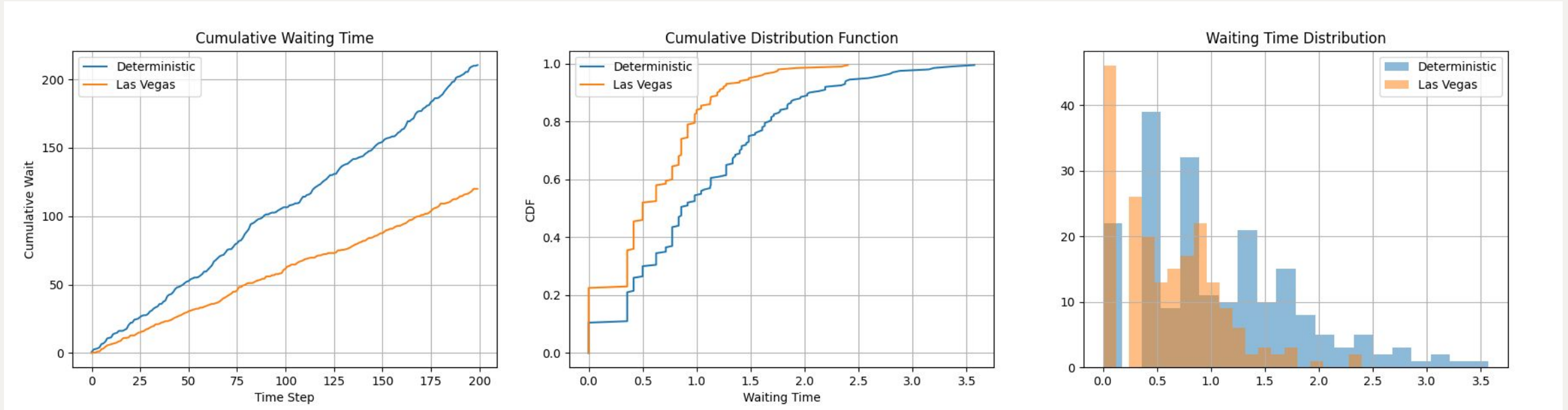
**Visualization of real-time
vehicle movement and
traffic flow at an
intersection in SUMO**

Results



Comparative analysis shows reduced waiting time and queue length using randomized optimization

Results



Improved CDF and distribution indicate faster service and reduced congestion

Inference – Domain Perspective

- **Traffic as a real world system :**

- Intersections behave like stochastic queuing systems.
- Vehicle arrivals are completely random and time-varying.
- Peak hour congestions result into non-linear queue buildup.

- **Limitations of deterministic control :**

- It assumes fixed time arrival inputs.
- It can't adopt to sudden traffic bursts.
- As a result, there are
 - Idle green signals
 - Increased waiting time

- **Advantages of Las Vegas approach :**

- Use of controlled randomness
- Effective handling of real-time fluctuations.
- Dynamically adjustments of signal timing.

- **System level Improvements :**

- Waiting time ↓
- Queue length ↓
- Throughput ↑
- Signal efficiency ↑

Traffic is stochastic → Control must be adaptive, not fixed.

Inference – Computer Science Perspective

- **System Characteristics :**

- Stochastic optimized problem.
- Real-time decision making system.

- **Algorithmic Insight :**

- Deterministic approach → ensures baseline performance.
- Las Vegas approach → enables exploration and improvement.

- **Key Properties :**

- Online algorithm (No prior training required).
- State-dependent decision logic.
- Hybrid deterministic-randomized framework.

References

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Rushin Modi - AU2440028

Philip Ryan Rocha - AU2320182

Naisha Dave - AU2440181

Aditi Kapadiya - AU2440139

Viranshul Panchal - AU2440209